

Italian urban planning

During the Renaissance, Italy was a collection of city states, each with its own ruler – the Pope in Rome, the Medici family in Florence, the Doge in Venice, the Sforza family in Milan and the Este family in Ferrara. Through intense rivalry, technical and artistic developments increased, and new towns and cities were planned and constructed. Strict building regulations were set, endorsed by architects' guilds. The new nobility, created by wealth through banking or trade, commissioned imposing palaces, cathedrals, churches and town halls, while streets were arranged around large squares, created for markets and socializing. Brunelleschi's discovery of a new technique for drawing linear perspective led to the development of detailed architectural drawings, enabling projects to be easily visualized and shared. As printing developed, the dissemination of these ideas became easier, too. In 1484–5, Leonardo da Vinci planned his ideal city, basing it on a geometric plan and integrating elegant buildings, canals and roads on two levels.



***The Ideal City* (1480–4) by Fra Carnevale exemplifies Italian Renaissance ideas about architecture.**